

Cisco IT

Lifecycle Transformation Design



Renewal Risk 2.0 Connected Insights Popup Research Findings

Exploratory Interviews and Concept Evaluation

Presented: November 21, 2023

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Short agenda

- 01 Executive Summary
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- 03 Next Steps
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Executive Summary

What is Renewal Risk 2.0 Connected Insights Popup?

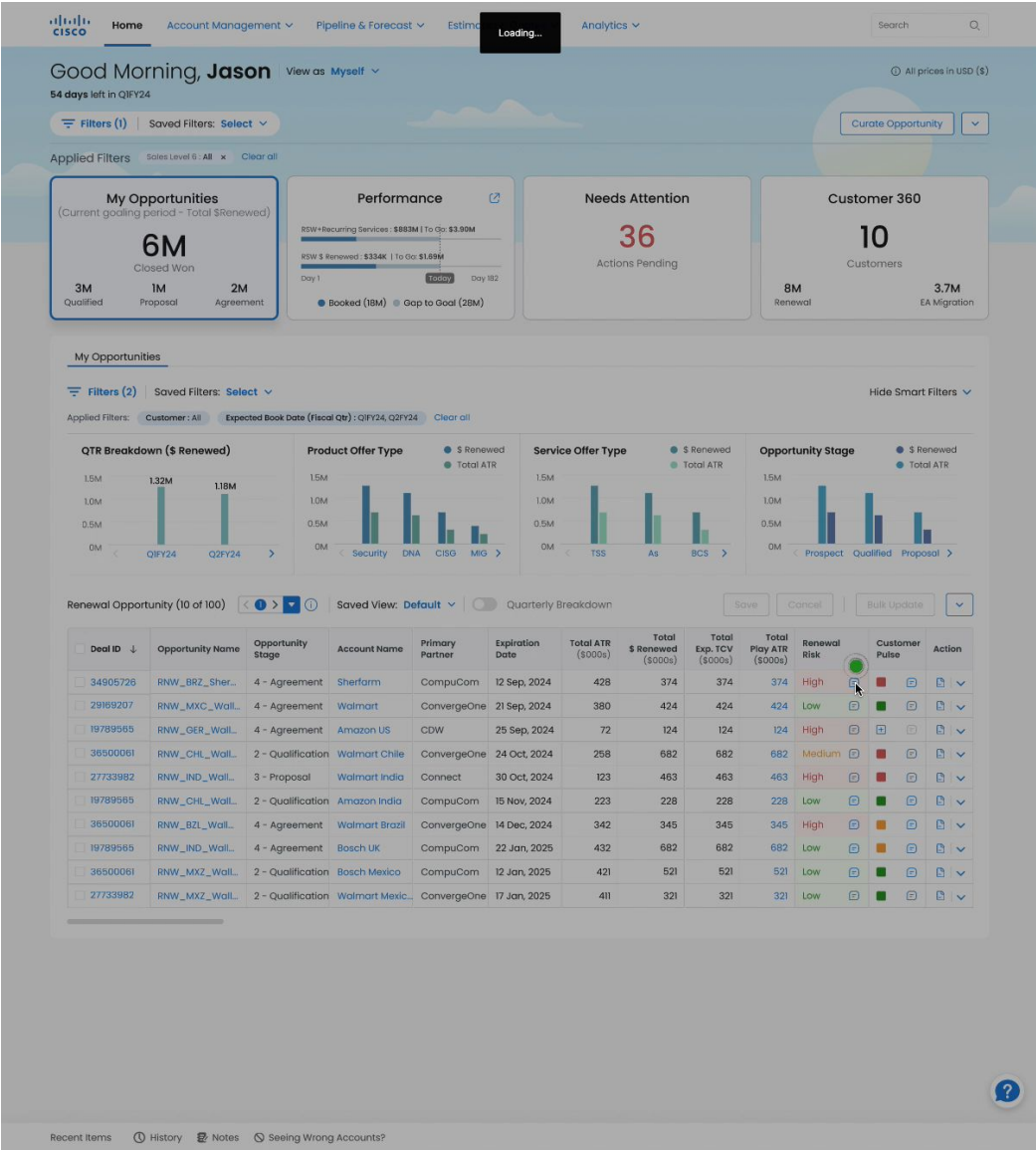
The Renewal Risk is predicted at not only a deal level but also a line-item level based on a renewal risk scoring system and risk models such as AI/ML.

The Connected Insights popup includes line item information with the Risk Status of the opportunity. Renewal Risk factors also be shown in the popup.

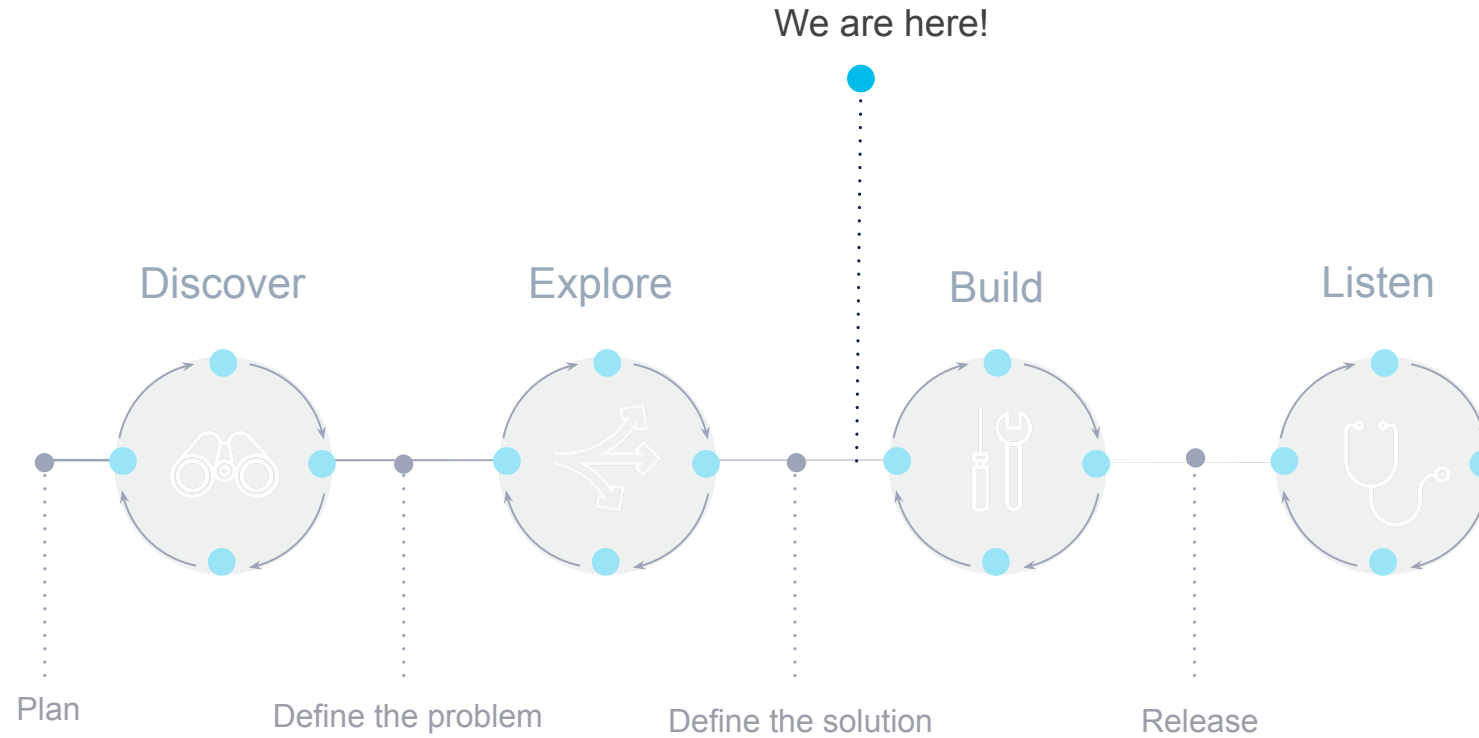
What we've done

The goal of the research is to validate how useful Renewal Risk and the Connected Insights popup contents are.

We interviewed 10 participants including renewals and customer success roles to know their current workflow and when they use Renewal Risk and to gather feedback on the proposed design concepts.



Where We Are

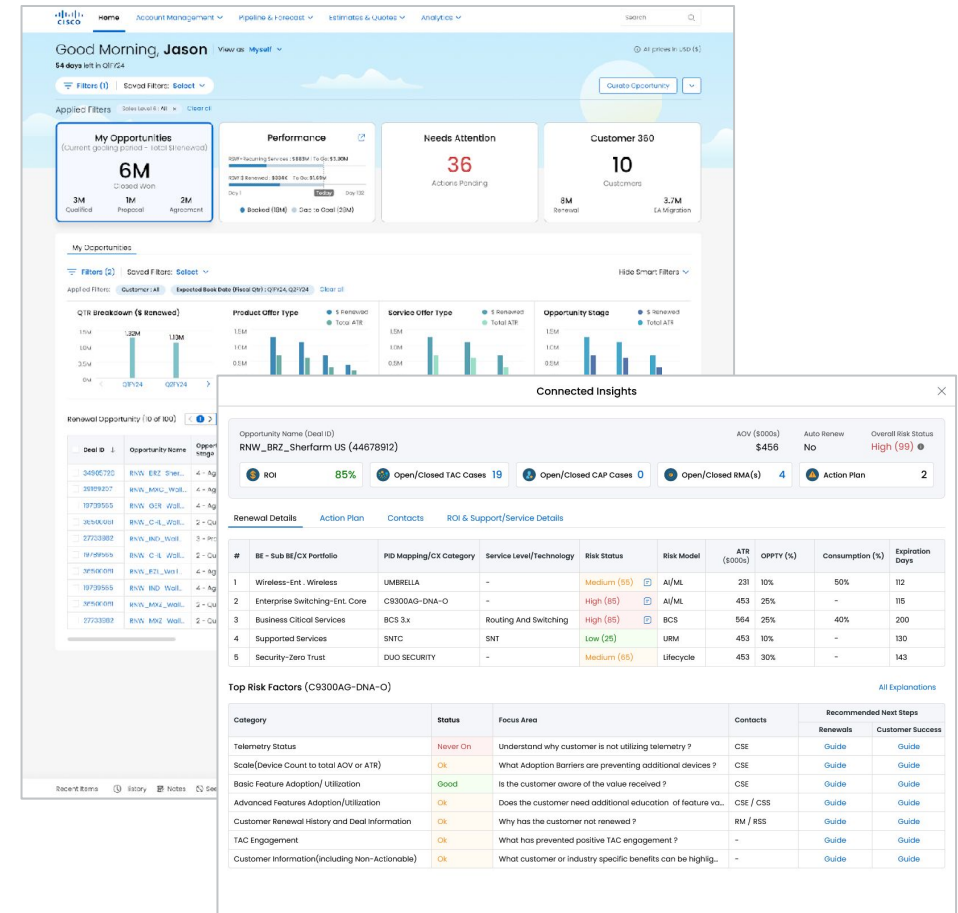


Connected Insights Popup

The Approach

Interviews were conducted to understand current workflows, usage of Renewal Risk and to evaluate design concepts

- 10 users (Participants breakdown attached to the next page)
- 40-minute sessions
- Discussion of the current workflows and usage of Renewal Risk
- Review of proposed designs – Figma prototype



Connected Insights Popup

Participants Breakdown

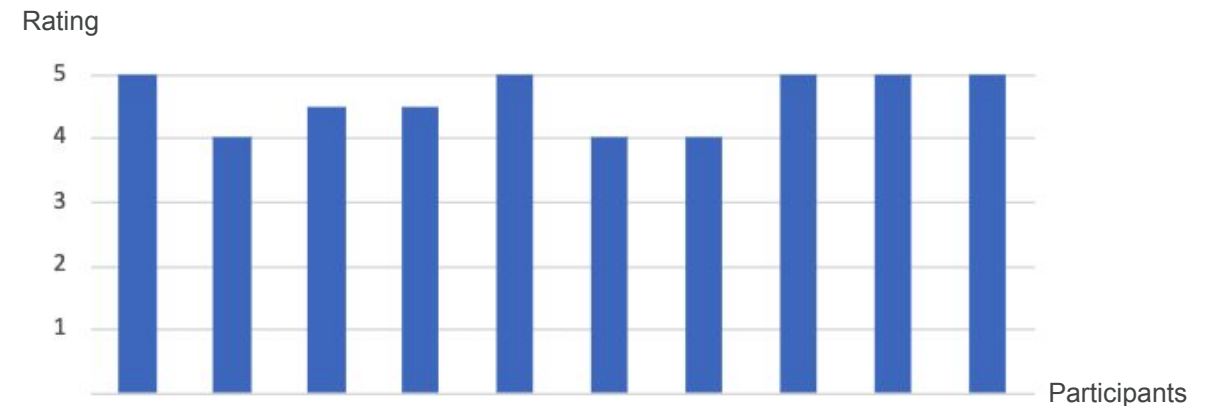
Participant Number	Title	Region	Organization	Years at Cisco Current Role	
1	Renewal Manager	Americas (US)	CX Renewals.Americas.Commercial - US Inv	2	2
2	Renewal Manager	EMEA	CX Renewals.EMEA.Germany - Germany	8	3.4
3	Customer Success Executive	Americas (US)	CX.Customer Success.AMER.USCom - USA	12	3.1
4	Renewal Specialist	Americas (US)	CX Renewals.Security.Americas - US	2	2
5	Customer Success Executive	Americas (US)	CX.Customer Success.AMER.USPS - USA	3	3
6	Customer Success Specialist	Americas (US)	CX.Customer Success.GCSS.AMER - USA	12	3.1
7	Customer Success Executive	Americas (US)	CX.Customer Success.AMER.GES West - USA	3	1.4
8	Leader, Renewal Specialist	EMEA	CX Renewals.BCS - Netherlands	26	2
9	Success Program Manager	EMEA	CX.Customer Success.EMEA.South - POL	3	1.4
10	Renewal Specialist	APJC	CX Renewals.Security.APJC - Korea	4	1.8

Connected Insights Popup

Key Takeaways

- Overall, all the roles said that the Connected Insights popup is very useful even though they have different use cases. Their overall usefulness rating is 4.6.
- When participants were asked how they would see more detailed information on the Renewal Risk, they mostly clicked the deal link rather than clicking the Connected Insights popup.
- Most participants found Renewal Risk Detail information, Action Plan, and Contacts information helpful. However, there are still places for improvement such as labeling or connections between information.

Q. On a scale from 1-5 where 1 is not at all useful and 5 is very useful, how useful do you find the "Connected Insights" pop-up in overall?



Key Findings

Connected Insights Popup is useful.

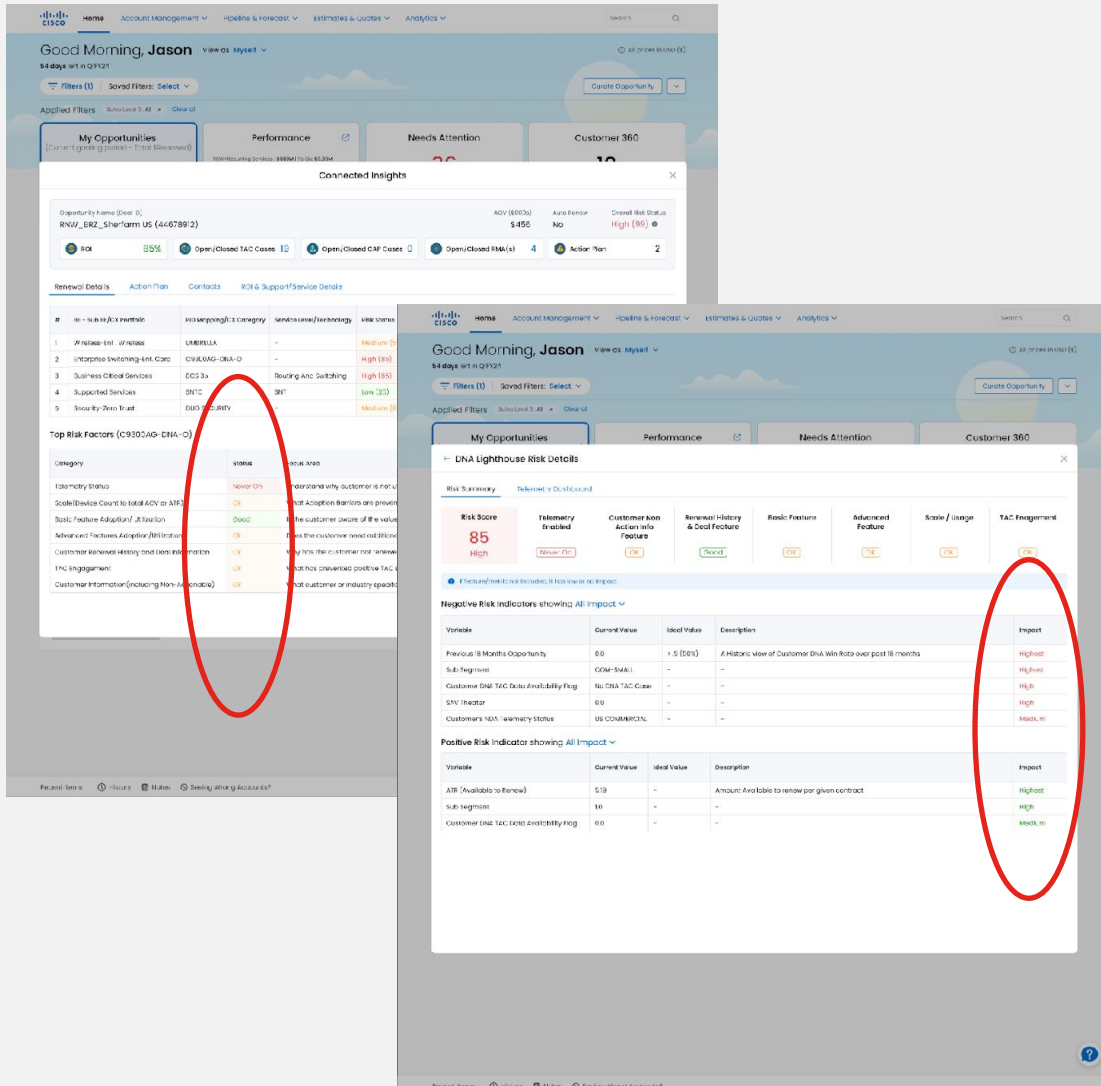
Users hesitated to use Renewal Risk at first since users doubted the accuracy of the risk model.

Users will click Deal ID instead of the bubble when trying to learn more about the Renewal Risk.

Users tended to want to work on the risk column (High, Medium, etc.) in the Top Risk Factors instead of the Guide links to learn more.

Users are confused by various terminology used in the interface ("Ok" and "Good" in Status in Top Risk Factors and "High" and "Highest" in Risk Summary>Impact).

Most users wanted to view items with High Renewal Risk and high ATR value first.



Key Recommendations

Increase reliability of the risk model and provide ease of use

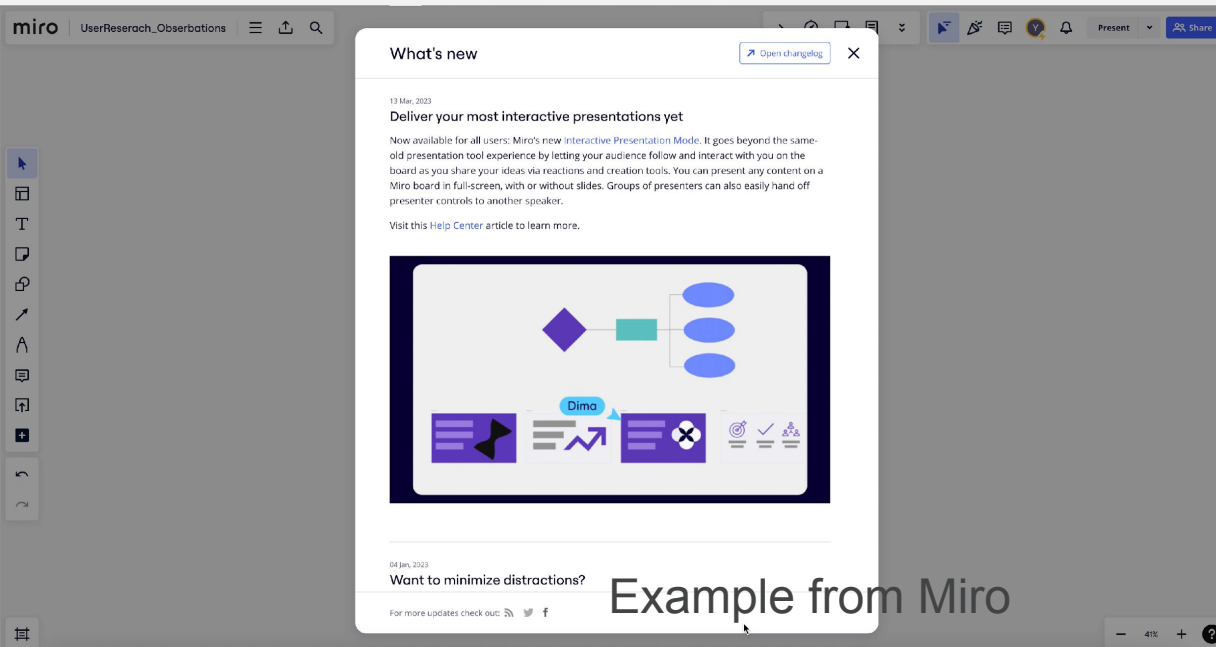
Consider providing brief explanation of risk model operation principles to increase reliability.

Consider having a quick guide session once users log in to the system like 'what's new' popup.

Consider moving Recommended Steps next to the Status or making it possible to click the status column.

Provide info icon and tooltips to explain terminology.

Save the users time by providing sorting option.



Example from Miro

Findings & Recommendations

“I would click on probably Deal ID or opportunity, I like going to deal ID. That's what I'm used to.”

Participant 5, CSE

Finding 1

Users hesitated to use Renewal Risk

Users currently have different use cases for the Renewal Risk depending on the role. Most users rarely use Renewal Risk for several reasons. And one of the reasons was doubt about the data accuracy.

However, once they experienced the Connected Insights popup, most users liked the provided concepts and functions and indicated that they were willing to use the Connected Insights popup.

"and that it's linked to the customer success dashboard and there is some telemetric going wrong, like taking an option and everything, but it's not that accurate. So, what I'm doing is, I just go to costumer or partner to ask.."

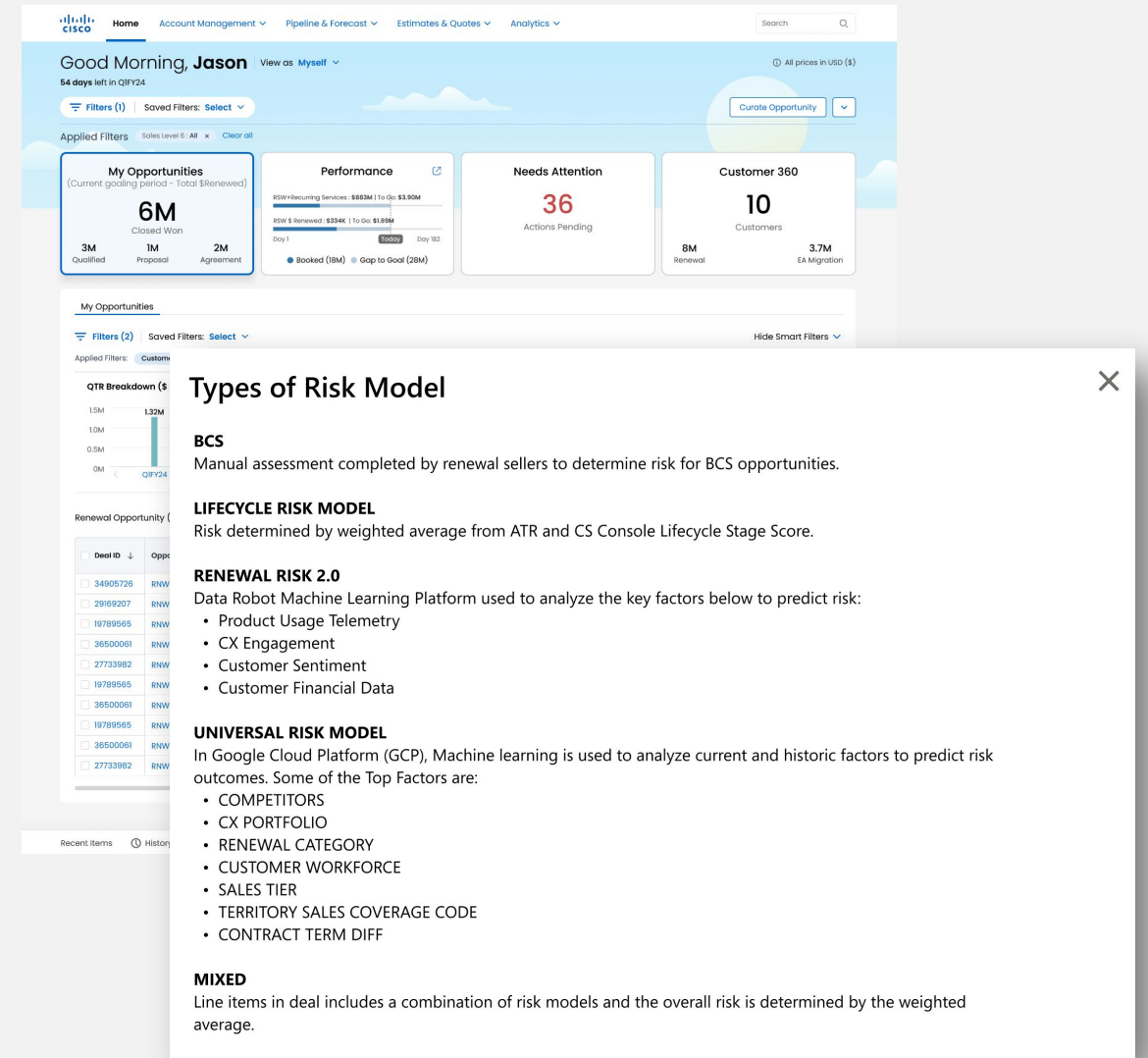
-Participant 10, RS

Recommendation 1

Consider providing brief risk model operation information

Provide an explanation of the Risk Model or how it works as further information in order to increase the reliability of the risk model data.

Also, consider providing feedback history or collaboration history like Customer Pulse. It helps to not only understand the risk but also give visibility helping increase trust regardless of roles.



The screenshot displays the Cisco CRM dashboard for user Jason. The dashboard includes sections for 'My Opportunities' (6M), 'Performance' (Revenue: \$583M), 'Needs Attention' (36 Actions Pending), and 'Customer 360' (10 Customers). A popup titled 'Types of Risk Model' is overlaid on the dashboard, listing four risk models: BCS, Lifecycle Risk Model, Renewal Risk 2.0, and Universal Risk Model. Each model is accompanied by a brief description and a list of factors used for risk assessment.

Types of Risk Model

BCS
Manual assessment completed by renewal sellers to determine risk for BCS opportunities.

LIFECYCLE RISK MODEL
Risk determined by weighted average from ATR and CS Console Lifecycle Stage Score.

RENEWAL RISK 2.0
Data Robot Machine Learning Platform used to analyze the key factors below to predict risk:

- Product Usage Telemetry
- CX Engagement
- Customer Sentiment
- Customer Financial Data

UNIVERSAL RISK MODEL
In Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Machine learning is used to analyze current and historic factors to predict risk outcomes. Some of the Top Factors are:

- COMPETITORS
- CX PORTFOLIO
- RENEWAL CATEGORY
- CUSTOMER WORKFORCE
- SALES TIER
- TERRITORY SALES COVERAGE CODE
- CONTRACT TERM DIFF

MIXED
Line items in deal includes a combination of risk models and the overall risk is determined by the weighted average.

Example of Popup

Finding 2

Users will click Deal ID instead of the bubble when trying to learn more about the Renewal Risk.

The first reaction of most users after seeing the Renewal Risk column was trying to click the deal ID or opportunity name rather than clicking the bubble to see the Connected Insights popup.

Users are used to clicking the deal ID and seeing the detailed information through the console.

"I would click into the opportunity. I don't know, probably on the deal ID, or the opportunity name."

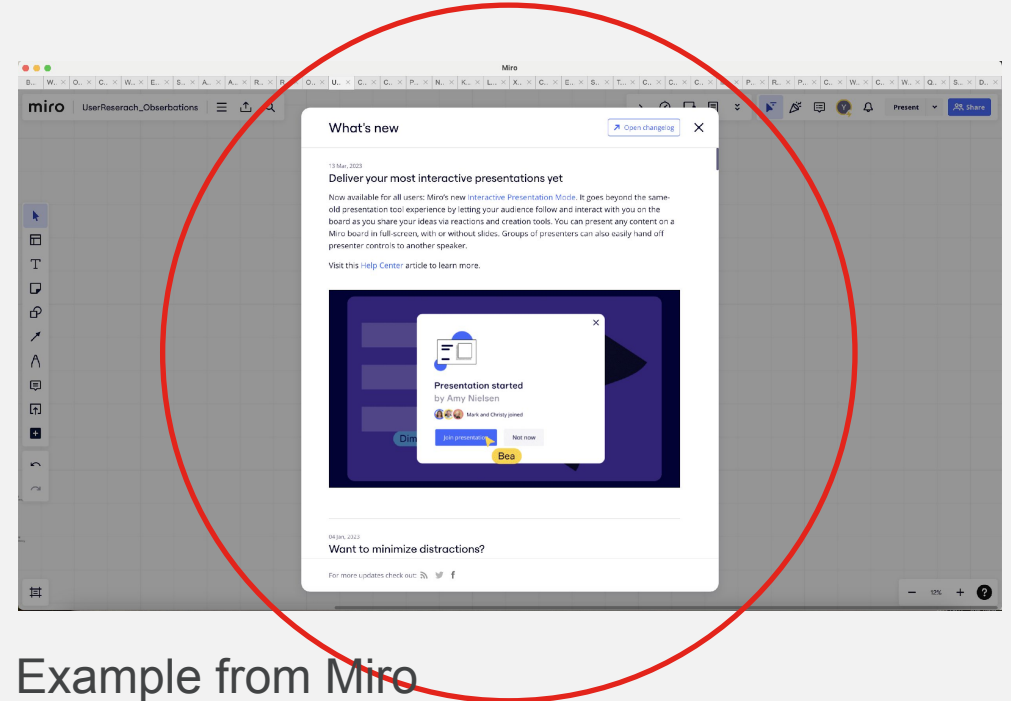
-Participant 1, RM

Recommendation 2

Consider having a quick guide session

It is hard for users to catch up on newly added functions right away in the system. So, we should kindly provide information on added features. Education or training sessions are also a great way to introduce new functions. However, it will be best to provide onto the system directly.

Therefore, consider having a quick guide session once users log in to the system like a 'what's new' popup.



Example from Miro

Finding 3

Users tended to want to click on the risk column in the Top Risk Factors

Users tended to want to click on the risk column (High, Medium, etc.) in the Top Risk Factors following the mental model from the main page of the Connected Insights popup.

"I would then probably go to status and click on see if, if they were highlight hyperlinked or something to."

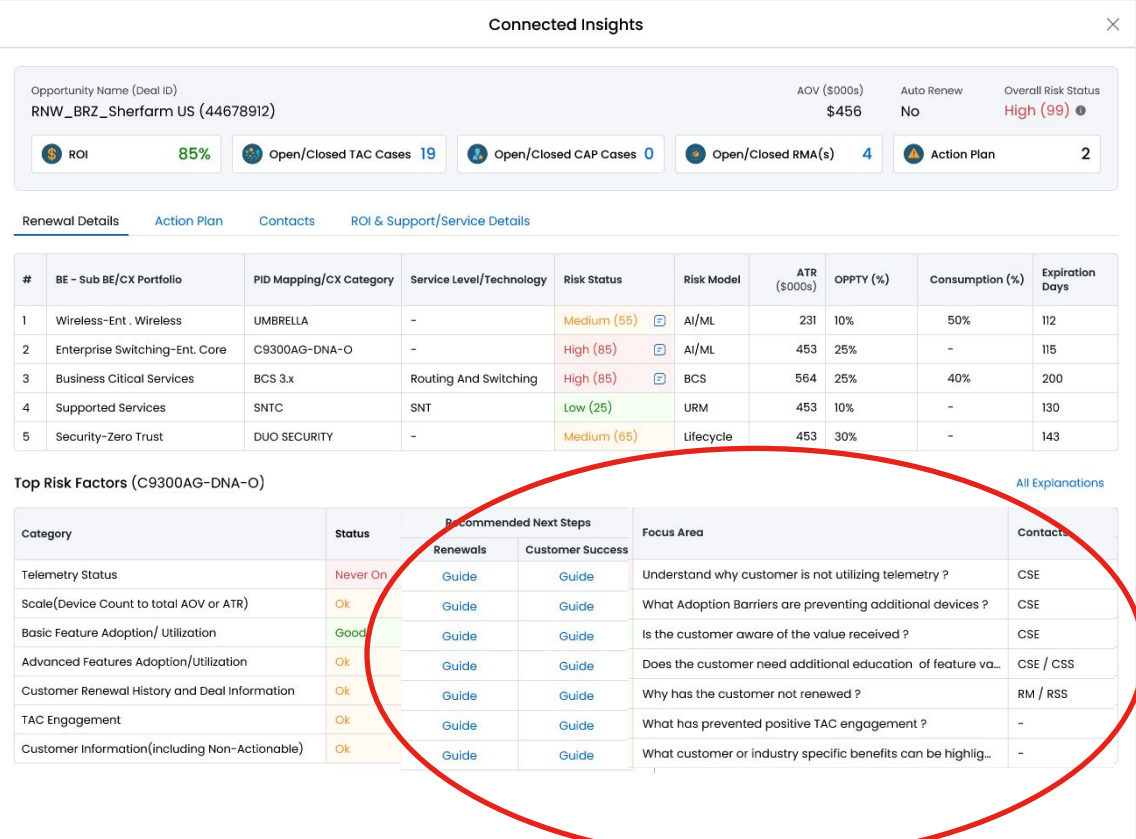
-Participant 5, CSE

Recommendation 3

Keep Behavior Pattern Consistency

Users tended to create their mental models or behavior patterns based on their past experience or learned experience while exploring the Connected Insights popup.

So, we should consider moving Recommended Steps next to the Status or making it possible to click the status column.



Recommended Next Steps are moved right next to the Status.

Finding 4

Users were confused by various terminology

Users tended to assume information based on their knowledge. If they don't have references for new information, users are confused or want to know the exact standard.

In the new Connected Insights popup, there are various sets of terminology being used ("OK" and "Good" in Status in Top Risk Factors and "High" and "Highest" in Risk Summary>Impact) . This caused confusion for users and they asked to know the exact standard.

The image displays two screenshots of the Cisco Connected Insights interface, illustrating user confusion with terminology.

Left Screenshot: Connected Insights Popup

The popup shows a table titled "Top Risk Factors (C9300AD-DNA-O)". The table has columns for Category, Status, and Risk Area. The Status column contains values like "Never OK", "Good", and "High". A red circle highlights the "Status" column.

Category	Status	Risk Area
Category	Status	Risk Area
Category	Never OK	Category
Category	Good	Category
Category	High	Category

Right Screenshot: DNA Lighthouse Risk Details Popup

The popup shows a table titled "Negative Risk Indicators showing All Impact". The table has columns for Variable, Current Value, Ideal Value, Description, and Impact. The Impact column contains values like "Highest", "High", and "Medium". A red circle highlights the "Impact" column.

Variable	Current Value	Ideal Value	Description	Impact
Previous 18 Months Opportunity	0.0	+ 5 (0.5)	A Historic view of Customer DNA Win Rate over past 18 months	Highest
Sub-Region	COM-STAT	-	-	High
Customer DNA TAC Data Availability Flag	No DNA TAC Data	-	-	High
SVN Theorist	0.0	-	-	Medium
Customer's NNA (Primary) Status	US COMMERCIAL	-	-	Medium

Recommendation 4

Provide information icons and tooltips to explain terminology

The best way to reduce confusion is to use the same terminology that users have used. But, the terminology is a bit different depending on the roles. So, it's hard to use unified terminology. Also, if it is a newly added concept terminology, there's no way to learn.

Instead of unifying, the simple way is to provide information icons and tooltips to explain terminology.

Also, we need to update some of the terminology such as All Explanations.



Example of Tooltip, showing hover over information

Finding 5

Most users wanted to see well-customized information

Most users wanted to save their time to deal with their opportunities. So, they wanted to prioritize their opportunities as they wanted.

Their top priority factors were Expiration Date, ATR, and Renewal Risk. So, when they decided to prioritize their work, users tended to want to sort their opportunities by high ATR, earlier expiration date, and high Renewal Risk.(7/10 participants)

"I think that Ah.. let me see, is there a way to filter or to order the high to low? That would be helpful."

-Participant 3, CSE

Recommendation 5

Save Time by Providing Sorting

We could see the sorting option next to the Deal ID in the designed prototype. We should also provide a quick sorting option for the Renewal Risk, ATR, or Expiration date.

Renewal Opportunity (10 of 100) Saved View: Default Quarterly Breakdown

Deal ID	Opportunity Name	Opportunity Stage	Account Name	Primary Partner	Expiration Date	Total ATR (\$000s)	Total \$ Renewed (\$000s)	Total Exp. TCV (\$000s)	Total Play ATR (\$000s)	Renewal Risk	Customer Pulse	Action
34905726	RNW_BRZ_Sher...	4 - Agreement	Sherfarm	CompuCom	12 Sep, 2024	428	374	374	374	High		
29169207	RNW_MXC_Wall...	4 - Agreement	Walmart	ConvergeOne	21 Sep, 2024	380	424	424	424	Low		
19789565	RNW_GER_Wall...	4 - Agreement	Amazon US	CDW	25 Sep, 2024	72	124	124	124	High		
36500061	RNW_CHL_Wall...	2 - Qualification	Walmart Chile	ConvergeOne	24 Oct, 2024	258	682	682	682	Medium		
27733982	RNW_IND_Wall...	3 - Proposal	Walmart India	Connect	30 Oct, 2024	123	463	463	463	High		
19789565	RNW_CHL_Wall...	2 - Qualification	Amazon India	CompuCom	15 Nov, 2024	223	228	228	228	Low		
36500061	RNW_BZL_Wall...	4 - Agreement	Walmart Brazil	ConvergeOne	14 Dec, 2024	342	345	345	345	High		
19789565	RNW_IND_Wall...	4 - Agreement	Bosch UK	CompuCom	22 Jan, 2025	432	682	682	682	Low		
36500061	RNW_MXZ_Wall...	2 - Qualification	Bosch Mexico	CompuCom	12 Jan, 2025	421	521	521	521	Low		
27733982	RNW_MXZ_Wall...	2 - Qualification	Walmart Mexic...	ConvergeOne	17 Jan, 2025	411	321	321	321	Low		

Breakdown

Total ATR (\$000s)	Total \$ Renewed (\$000s)	Total Exp. TCV (\$000s)	Total Play ATR (\$000s)	Renewal Risk	Customer Pulse
428	374	374	374	High	
380	424	424	424	Low	
72	124	124	124	High	
258	682	682	682	Medium	
123	463	463	463	High	
223	228	228	228	Low	
342	345	345	345	High	
432	682	682	682	Low	
421	521	521	521	Low	
411	321	321	321	Low	

Next Steps

Key Findings and Recommendations

Finding	Recommendation	Discussion/Action
1- Users tended to doubt the accuracy of the risk model and hesitated to use Renewal Risk.	• Provide an explanation of the Risk Model or how it works as further information in order to increase the reliability of the risk model data. • Also, consider providing feedback history or collaboration history like Customer Pulse. It helps to not only understand the risk but also give visibility helping increase trust regardless of roles.	• DB – we have those explanations, can provide to GK, maybe can put it in • GK – can add info in headers within next few days • DB – Customer Pulse planned for March, aligning with CS team
2 – Users will click Deal ID instead of the bubble when trying to learn more about the Renewal Risk.	• It is hard for users to catch up on newly added functions right away in the system. So, we should kindly provide information on added features. Education or training sessions are also a great way to introduce new functions. However, it will be best to provide onto the system directly. • Therefore, consider having a quick guide session once users log in to the system like a 'what's new' popup.	• GK – we don't have any framework here, would use WalkMe • MT – yes we can sit down and look at what we need here for WalkMe, will sit down with Kalyan and Danielle, call scheduled for Dec 5 – need to start this sooner next time • GK – think about video training, help to click on • MB – this will be part of Feb release and there will be deep dive sessions with each geo on risk the week after the release, will share change plan • MiHa – was this an issue with where to click?
3 – Users tended to want to click on the risk column (High, Medium, etc.) in the Top Risk Factors instead of the Guide links to learn more.	• Keep behavior pattern consistent. • Users tended to create their mental models or behavior patterns based on their past experience or learned experience while exploring the Connected Insights popup. • So, we should consider moving Recommended Steps next to the Status or making it possible to click the status column.	• GK – talking about Top Risk Factors – we calculate the Status, then focus area column and who needs to be contacted, then Guide gives next step • DB – can we put a tooltip? Can talk to operations team

Key Findings and Recommendations

Finding

Recommendation

Discussion/Action

4- Users are confused by various terminology used in the interface ("Ok" and "Good" in Status in Top Risk Factors and "High" and "Highest" in Risk Summary>Impact).

- Provide tooltips to explain terminology.
- The best way to reduce confusion is to use the same terminology that users have used. But, the terminology is a bit different depending on the roles. So, it's hard to use unified terminology. Also, if it is a newly added concept terminology, there's no way to learn.
- Instead of unifying, the simple way is to provide information icons and tooltips to explain terminology.
- Also, we need to update some of the terminology such as All Explanations.

- GK – 95% of ppl don't use tooltip icons
- MT – they don't use the bubbles
- MaHa – better to improve the design than rely on trainings – we should standardize what these colors and terms mean
- GK – we need to come up with standards
- DB – header has definition of High, Medium, Low

5 - Most users want to view items with High Renewal Risk and high ATR value first.

- Save the users time by providing sorting option.
- We could see the sorting option next to the Deal ID in the designed prototype. We should also provide a quick sorting option for the Renewal Risk, ATR, or Expiration date.

- RP – Sorting is planned, right?
- GK – Yes, targeting March release
- RP – planning to make the columns more customizable – let them reorder the columns
- DB – do they want to sort within the pop-up?
- YC – better to have in both places

11/21 Readout attendees: Yoomi Cha, Mary Hatch, Danielle Bousso, Dennis Charlebois, Gautam Rao, Gowthaman Krishnamurthy, Marirosa Toledo, Mike Hall, Rima Philip, Wayne Lewis, Rohit Rande, Mike Hall

Next Steps

Successes

Valid feedback was gathered with sufficient time for design updates ahead of development.

- 10 users engaged
- Various roles and geographies
- Strong product management stakeholder engagement

Next Steps

Consider the bigger picture

- Collaboration with Gowthaman Krishnamurthy's team for the recommendations since the current design work is being proceeded by his team.
- Develop artifacts to clearly explain the Renewal Risk and details
- Research on different roles with the same contents (Some of them are done but if needed further)
- **All participants answered 'Yes' for the UAT test**

Considerations

Implications

This report should be used to support current tactical design and development decisions and should open up further lines of research.

Risks & Blockers

This feature release is being targeted for February 2024.

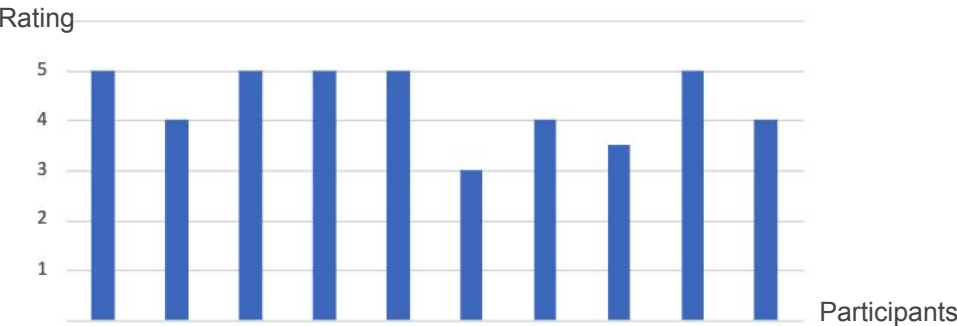
- Benchmarking and measurement programs should be put in place if possible
- How can we encourage tighter collaboration with strategy and planning, go-to-market, and change management teams?



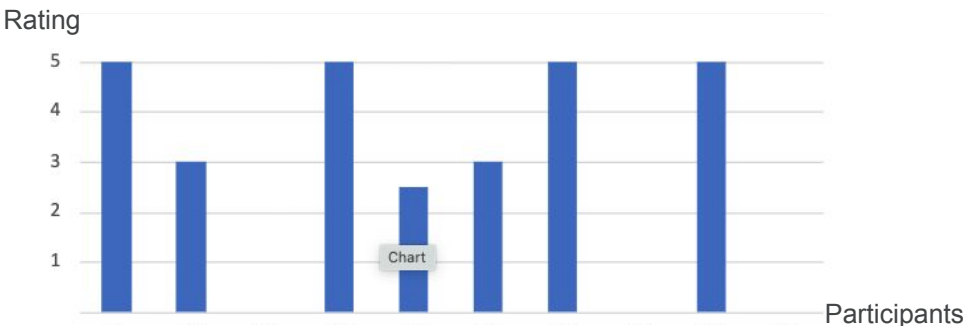
Appendix

Rating Graphs

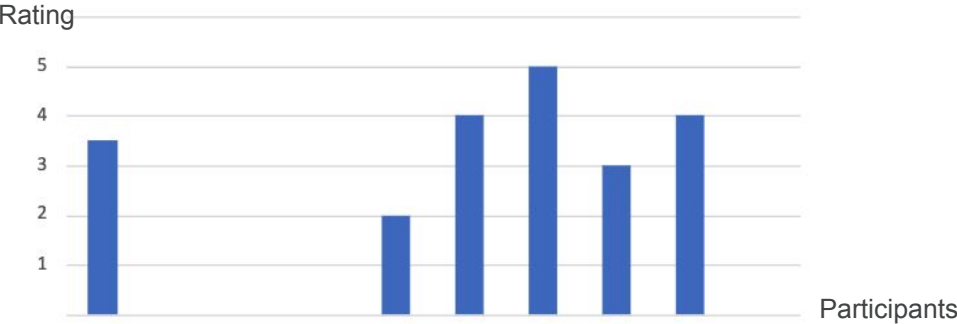
Q. On a scale from 1-5 where 1 is not at all useful and 5 is very useful, how useful do you find the **"Renewal Risk Column"** pop-up?



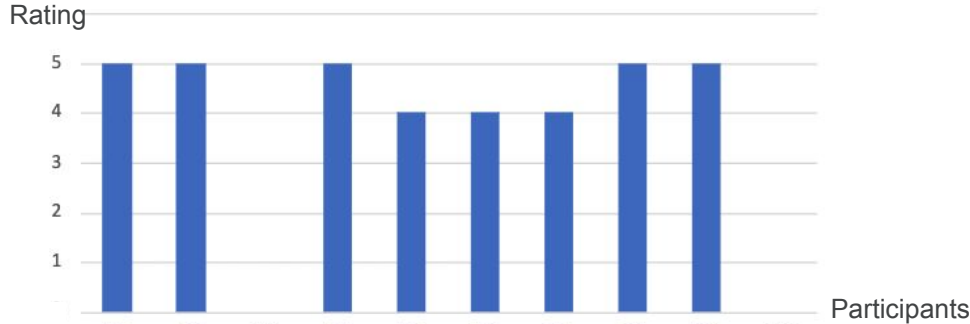
Q. On a scale from 1-5 where 1 is not at all useful and 5 is very useful, how useful do you find the **"Connected Insights"** pop-up?



Q. On a scale from 1-5 where 1 is not at all useful and 5 is very useful, how useful do you find the **"BCS Risk Factors"** pop-up?

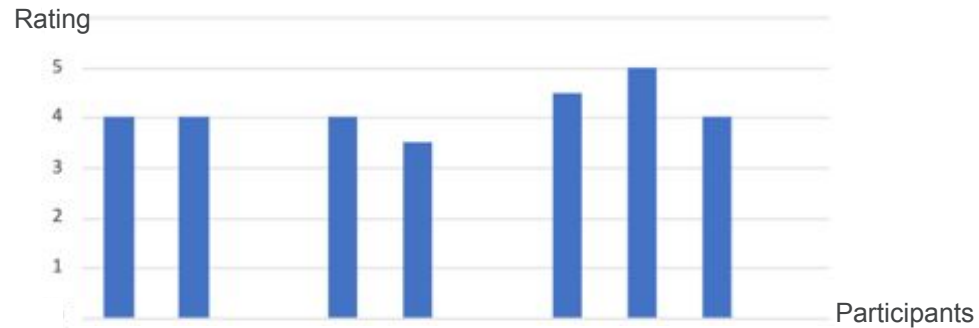


Q. On a scale from 1-5 where 1 is not at all useful and 5 is very useful, how useful do you find the **"AI/ML Risk Factors"** pop-up?

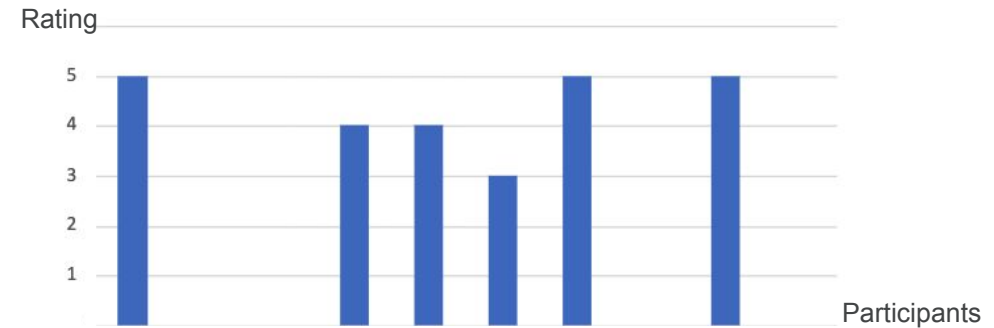


Rating Graphs

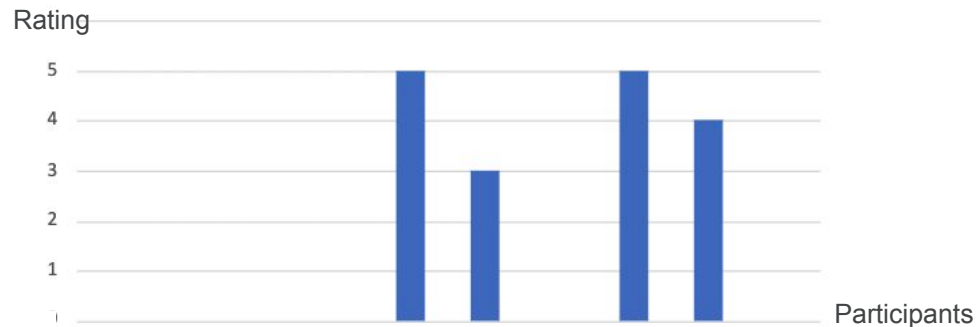
Q. On a scale from 1-5 where 1 is not at all useful and 5 is very useful, how useful do you find the "**All Explanations**" pop-up?



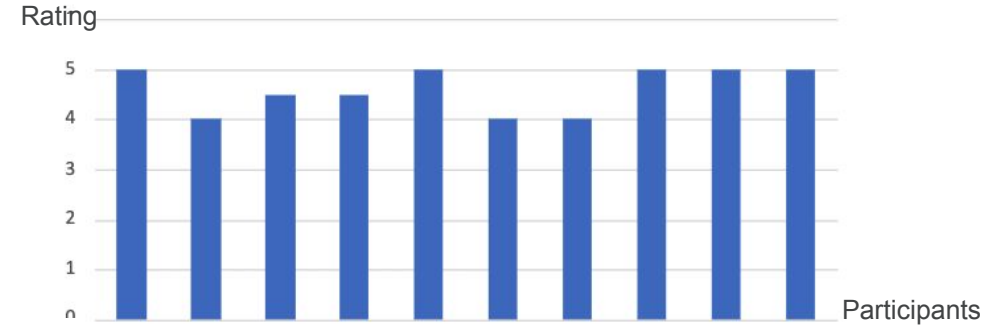
Q. On a scale from 1-5 where 1 is not at all useful and 5 is very useful, how useful do you find the "**Action Plan**" pop-up?



Q. On a scale from 1-5 where 1 is not at all useful and 5 is very useful, how useful do you find the "**Contacts**" pop-up?



Q. On a scale from 1-5 where 1 is not at all useful and 5 is very useful, how useful do you find the "**Connected Insights**" pop-up?



Appendix

Resources

Project Links

- JIRA links (Research, Design, Engineering epic)
- [Research Plan](#)
- [Figma Link](#)
- [Discussion Guide](#)
- [Participant Tracker](#) (locked for participant privacy)
- [Session Notes](#)

Process

- [WFXD Design Process.pptx](#)

Contacts

IT Design Lifecycle Transformation Design Team

- Yoomi Cha, UX Designer
- Mary Hatch, UX Research Lead

Stakeholder Department

- Dennis Charlebois, Leader, Product Owner
- Danielle Bousso, Business Analysis Manager
- Nitish Aggarwal, Customer Experience Product Manager
- Rima Philip, Leader, Product Owner

Report Readout

Research Readout – Renewal Risk 2.0

Connected Insights Popup (Password: VitZSXp3)